

Word family: **patron / patrons / patronage / patronise / patronize / patronising / patronizing**

Base word: patron

Plural: patrons

Related forms: patronage, patronise/patronize, patronising/patronizing, patronisingly/patronizingly

Lower-priority forms: patroness, patronal

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Other **patrons** then bear the consequences.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **patrons** means **customers who use a restaurant, café, bar, theatre, or similar establishment**.

繁體中文： **顧客；光顧某間餐廳、咖啡店或其他場所的人**

中文翻譯：

> “Other **patrons** then bear the consequences.”

「其他**顧客**便要承受後果。」

Here:

restaurant patrons = 餐廳顧客 / 食客

Patron is slightly more formal than ordinary **customer** and is especially natural for restaurants, bars, hotels, theatres, libraries, cultural venues, and similar establishments.

1. **patron = customer of a business or establishment (顧客) — 顧客；光顧者**

This is the **exact passage sense**.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Other **patrons** may struggle to find a seat.”

「其他**顧客**可能很難找到座位。」

Practice 2

> “The café asks **patrons** not to occupy large tables when it is busy.”

「咖啡店請**顧客**在繁忙時不要佔用大桌。」

Practice 3

> “The restaurant can accommodate eighty **patrons**.”

「這間餐廳可以容納八十名**顧客 / 食客**。」

patron = 經常或當時正在使用某間商業、文化或服務場所的人

Common:

* restaurant patron

* bar patron

* theatre patron

* hotel patron

* library patron

2. **patron** = user/visitor of an institution or facility (使用者) — 使用者；訪客

The person does not always need to be buying something.

For example:

> **library patron**

usually means a person who uses the library.

Practice 4

> “Library **patrons** can borrow up to ten books.”

「圖書館**使用者 / 讀者**最多可以借十本書。」

Practice 5

> “The museum provides lockers for its **patrons**.”

「博物館為**訪客**提供儲物櫃。」

The underlying concept remains:

> ****a person who uses or frequents an establishment****

So I would merge this with Meaning 1 rather than create a new core sense.

3. ****patron = person who supports an artist, organization, cause, etc. (贊助者) — 贊助人 ; 支持者****

This is the other major meaning of ****patron****.

A patron can provide:

- * money
- * resources
- * influence
- * protection
- * public support

Practice 6

> “The artist depended on wealthy ****patrons****.”

「那位藝術家依靠富有的****贊助人****支持。」

Practice 7

> “She became a major ****patron**** of the arts.”

「她成為藝術界的重要****贊助人 / 支持者****。」

****patron = 長期以金錢、資源、影響力或其他方式支持某人、藝術、組織或事業的人****

Common:

- * patron of the arts
- * wealthy patron
- * generous patron
- * patron of a charity

This meaning historically helps explain why ****patron**** can mean a loyal customer: the customer financially supports the establishment through their business.

4. **patron = official/honorary supporter of an organization (正式角色) — 贊助人；名譽支持者**

Organizations and charities may appoint a prominent individual as their **patron**.

Such a person may:

- * publicly support the organization;
- * lend their name or prestige;
- * attend events;
- * help raise awareness or funding.

Practice 8

> “She serves as a **patron** of the charity.”

「她擔任該慈善機構的**贊助人 / 名譽支持者**。」

This does not necessarily mean the patron personally pays all the organization's costs.

For strict counting, this belongs to Meaning 3.

5. **patron = protector/supporter of someone dependent on them (歷史 / 正式) — 保護人；庇護者**

Historically, **patron** could refer more broadly to a powerful person who gave protection, support, influence, or resources to someone of lower status.

Practice 9

> “The writer sought the protection of an influential **patron**.”

「那位作家尋求一位有影響力的**庇護者 / 贊助人**支持。」

This historical relationship is the source of much of the modern sponsorship meaning.

Database status: genuine background sense, but usually merge with “supporter/sponsor” for modern learners.

6. **patron saint = saint regarded as a special protector (宗教固定詞組) — 主保聖人；守護聖人**

A **patron saint** is a saint traditionally regarded as the particular protector or advocate of:

- * a place
- * profession
- * group
- * activity
- * institution

Practice 10

> “The church is named after its **patron saint**.”

「這座教堂以其**主保聖人 / 守護聖人**命名。」

This is an established fixed expression.

The meaning develops from:

> **patron = protector**

rather than from **customer**.

7. **patron = person with certain ecclesiastical appointment rights (教會 / 法律 , 專門)**

In some historical and ecclesiastical contexts, especially involving the Church of England, a **patron** can refer to a person or body holding the right to present a candidate to a church benefice.

繁體中文 : 可按語境譯為 **聖職推薦權持有人 / 教會贊助權持有人**

This is a genuine specialist sense but far too narrow for the ordinary learner core.

Related form: **patronage**

Patronage is especially important because it develops several branches.

1. **patronage = business given by customers (惠顧) — 惠顧 ; 光顧**

You often see:

> “Thank you for your **patronage**.”

= 「感謝您的**惠顧**。」

Practice 11

> “The shop relies on the **patronage** of local residents.”

「這間店依靠當地居民的**惠顧**。」

This is the noun counterpart of **patron = customer**.

2. **patronage = financial/influential support (贊助) — 贊助；資助；支持**

Practice 12

> “The arts flourished under royal **patronage**.”

「藝術在皇室**贊助 / 支持**下蓬勃發展。」

Practice 13

> “Without private **patronage**, many artists struggled financially.”

「沒有私人**贊助**，很多藝術家的經濟狀況都很困難。」

This belongs to the supporter/sponsor branch.

3. **patronage = giving positions/favours because of connections or support (制度 / 政治) — 任人唯親式的職位 / 利益分配；庇護制度**

In political or organizational history, **patronage** can mean distributing:

- * jobs
- * appointments
- * contracts
- * benefits

to supporters or associates rather than purely through open merit-based competition.

Practice 14

> “The historian examined networks of political **patronage**.”

「那位歷史學家研究政治上的**庇護 / 職位利益分配網絡**。」

This is a well-established specialist/social-institutional meaning.

It is related to the older idea of a powerful patron providing benefits to dependants or supporters.

Related verb: **patronise / patronize**

This word is especially important because it has **two very different modern meanings**.

British spelling:

> **patronise**

American spelling:

> **patronize**

8. **patronise/patronize = be a customer of a business (光顧) — 光顧 ; 惠顧**

Practice 15

> “Local residents regularly **patronise** the café.”

「當地居民經常**光顧**這間咖啡店。」

Practice 16

> “We prefer to **patronize** independent shops.”

「我們比較喜歡**光顧**獨立商店。」

patronise a business = 成為它的顧客，透過消費支持其生意

This is the verb counterpart of your passage sense.

9. **patronise/patronize = support or sponsor someone/something (贊助) — 贊助 ; 支持**

A more formal/historical use:

Practice 17

> “Wealthy families **patronised** local artists.”

「富裕家庭**資助** / **贊助**當地藝術家。」

This belongs to the patron-as-supporter branch.

10. **patronise/patronize** = treat someone as if they are less intelligent or capable (貶低) — 居高臨下地對待；以高人一等的口吻說話

This is now a very important everyday meaning—and easily confused with the positive meanings above.

Practice 18

> “Please don’t **patronise** me.”

「請不要用**居高臨下的態度**對我。」

Practice 19

> “He spoke to the staff in a **patronising** tone.”

「他用一種**居高臨下、把人當成不懂事**的語氣跟員工說話。」

patronise someone = 用彷彿自己更聰明、更成熟或地位更高的方式對待某人，使對方感到被看低

This is a genuinely separate major sense.

Related form: **patronising / patronizing**

In ordinary modern English, the adjective **patronising/patronizing** almost always means:

> **condescending**

Practice 20

> “Her explanation sounded **patronising**.”

「她的解釋聽起來有點**居高臨下** / 像把別人當小孩子。」

Important:

> **a patronising customer**

normally does **not** mean “a customer who gives business.”

It means:

> **a customer behaving condescendingly**

Context and grammatical form matter.

Related form: **patronisingly / patronizingly**

Practice 21

> “‘You’ll understand when you’re older,’ he said **patronisingly**.”

「『你長大後就會明白。』他用**居高臨下的口吻**說。」

Useful, though lower frequency than **patronising**.

Related form: **patroness**

Historically, **patroness** means a female patron.

Modern English normally uses gender-neutral:

> **patron**

for both men and women.

So **patroness** is genuine but dated/low priority.

Related form: **patronal**

Patronal means relating to a patron or patron saint.

For example:

> patronal festival

= celebrating a church's patron saint.

This is rare/specialist and not suitable for the learner core.

Important distinction: **patron vs customer**

customer

is the ordinary general word for someone who buys goods or services.

patron

is somewhat more formal and particularly common for people using:

- * restaurants
- * bars
- * theatres
- * libraries
- * cultural venues
- * establishments

Compare:

> supermarket customers

> restaurant patrons

Both are possible, but **customer** is broader and more neutral.

Important distinction: **patron vs client**

client

usually receives professional or specialized services:

- * lawyer's client
- * consultant's client
- * therapist's client

patron

usually frequents or uses an establishment:

- * café patron
- * theatre patron

A restaurant diner is naturally a **patron**, not usually a **client**.

Important distinction: **patron** vs **guest**

guest

emphasizes hospitality or being welcomed.

patron

emphasizes being a user/customer of the establishment.

Restaurants and hotels may deliberately call customers **guests** for hospitality purposes, but the words are not identical.

Important distinction: **patron** vs **sponsor**

sponsor

usually provides money/resources for a specific:

- * event
- * project
- * person
- * activity

often in exchange for publicity or another benefit.

patron

traditionally suggests broader or ongoing support, especially of:

- * artists
- * arts
- * charities
- * cultural institutions

There is considerable overlap.

Important distinction: **patron vs donor**

donor

gives money, property, blood, organs, etc.

patron

may provide money, but can also provide:

- * influence
- * public support
- * protection
- * continuing custom

So not every patron is simply a donor.

Important distinction: **patron vs supporter**

supporter

is very broad.

patron

often implies a more established relationship of material, financial, institutional, or influential support.

Important distinction: **patronise vs support**

This one causes many mistakes.

> “I patronise that café.”

can mean:

> 「我經常**光顧**那間咖啡店。」

But:

> “Don’t patronise me.”

means:

> 「不要**居高臨下地對我**。」

The object tells you which meaning is intended.

Important distinction: **patronising vs polite/helpful**

Someone can intend to be helpful yet sound **patronising** if they speak as though the other person is incapable of understanding ordinary things.

So:

> patronising ≠ merely polite

> patronising ≠ simply giving advice

The crucial element is the implied superiority.

Grammar note: **patron of**

For sponsorship/support:

> patron of the arts

> patron of the charity

> patron of a cultural organization

Grammar note: **patronise + establishment**

For the customer sense:

> patronise local restaurants

> patronize independent shops

No preposition is needed.

Grammar note: **patronise + person**

Be careful:

> “He patronised me.”

will normally be understood as:

> **他以居高臨下的態度對待我。 **

not:

> “He financially supported me.”

unless a clearly historical/formal context establishes that meaning.

Countability note

Patron is countable:

> a patron

> several patrons

Patronage is normally uncountable:

> customer patronage

> artistic patronage

> political patronage

Not normally:

> “a patronage” ❌

except in specialized historical/institutional classifications.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **patron**

* **patrons**
 * **patronage**
 * **patronise / patronize**
 * **patronised / patronized**
 * **patronising / patronizing**
 * **patronisingly / patronizingly**

Lower-priority:

* **patroness** — dated female-specific form
 * **patronal** — specialist

The family is especially useful because it splits into three semantic networks:

1. **customer / custom**
2. **supporter / sponsor / protector**
3. **condescending treatment** in modern **patronise/patronizing**

That third branch has moved far enough semantically that it must be explicitly separated.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
patron — customer	光顧 / 使用某間餐廳、酒吧、劇院、圖書館等場所的人；顧客 / 使用者
patron — supporter	以金錢、資源、影響力或其他方式支持藝術家、組織、事業等的人
patron — honorary supporter	正式與機構聯繫並提供聲望、宣傳或支持的名譽贊助人
patron — protector, historical	為他人提供保護、資源或庇護的人；較歷史 / 正式
patron saint	特別被視為某地、群體、職業或活動守護者的主保聖人
patronage — customer	顧客對店舖 / 企業的惠顧、生意支持
patronage — sponsorship	對藝術、機構、個人等提供的資助 / 庇護
patronage — institutional/political	透過權力關係把職位、利益等分配給支持者的庇護制度
patronise/patronize — customer	光顧某間店 / 企業
patronise/patronize — support	贊助 / 庇護某人或藝術活動；較正式或歷史
patronise/patronize — condescend	用高人一等、彷彿對方能力較低的態度對待某人
patronising/patronizing	居高臨下的；帶有把別人看低的態度

For your original sentence

> “Other **patrons** then bear the consequences.”

The exact meaning is:

****patrons = 正在餐廳用餐或希望使用餐廳服務的其他顧客 / 食客****

So:

> ****other patrons****

= ****其他顧客 / 其他食客****

The word is slightly more formal than ****customers****, and fits the editorial tone well.

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****patron**** itself:

1. ****customer/user of an establishment****
2. ****financial or influential supporter/sponsor****
3. ****protector/supporter in formal or historical usage****

I would keep ****patron saint**** as an important fixed extension and the ecclesiastical sense as low-priority specialist material. For the whole family, however, ****patronise/patronize = treat condescendingly**** absolutely needs its own prominent branch because its modern meaning is highly common and no longer predictable from ****patron = supporter/customer****.